

7 ways a submittal log goes sideways before kickoff

A field-friendly carousel for PEs, PMs, and anyone who has ever said “just build the log.”

SubPro: cleaner first-pass submittal logs before handoff

The log usually fails before the software sees it

Procore, Excel, Bluebeam, Autodesk — they all inherit whatever the first pass gives them.

If the first-pass submittal log is messy, downstream workflow just makes the mess official.

FIRST-PASS LOG ROW

Section	07 42 13
Item	wall panels
Need by	???
Source	missing
Review	guess

Failure #1: source context disappears

A row without a spec section or source page is not “clean.” It is a future argument with a due date.

07 42 13 // PRODUCT DATA // see p. 184

SubPro angle: keep the row reviewable, not magical.

Failure #2: long-leads show up late

The long-lead item did not become urgent during procurement. It was usually visible in the spec book first.



If the first-pass log does not surface it, the project still pays attention later — just with less time.

Failure #3: ownership is “somebody”

Dates and responsibility do not clean themselves up. A good log makes the next owner obvious.

OWNER

PE? PM?

REVIEW BY

TBD

NEEDED BY

yesterday

A better first pass does not need to be fancy

spec section

description

source page

confidence flag

owner / date

handoff-ready row

The goal is not autonomous judgment.
The goal is a cleaner row a PM/PE can
review faster.

Which row would you trust?

FIRST-PASS LOG ROW

Section	07 42 13
Item	wall panels
Need by	???
Source	missing
Review	guess

FIRST-PASS LOG ROW

Section	07 42 13
Item	wall panels
Need by	before enclosure
Source	spec p. 184
Review	PE check

The second row is not “done.” It is just easier to review without detective work.

Your turn

When a submittal log gets messy, what usually caused it?

A requirements missed in the spec

B ownership / dates unclear

C bad rows inherited downstream

D long-leads not visible early

Comment with the letter — but the reason is the useful part.